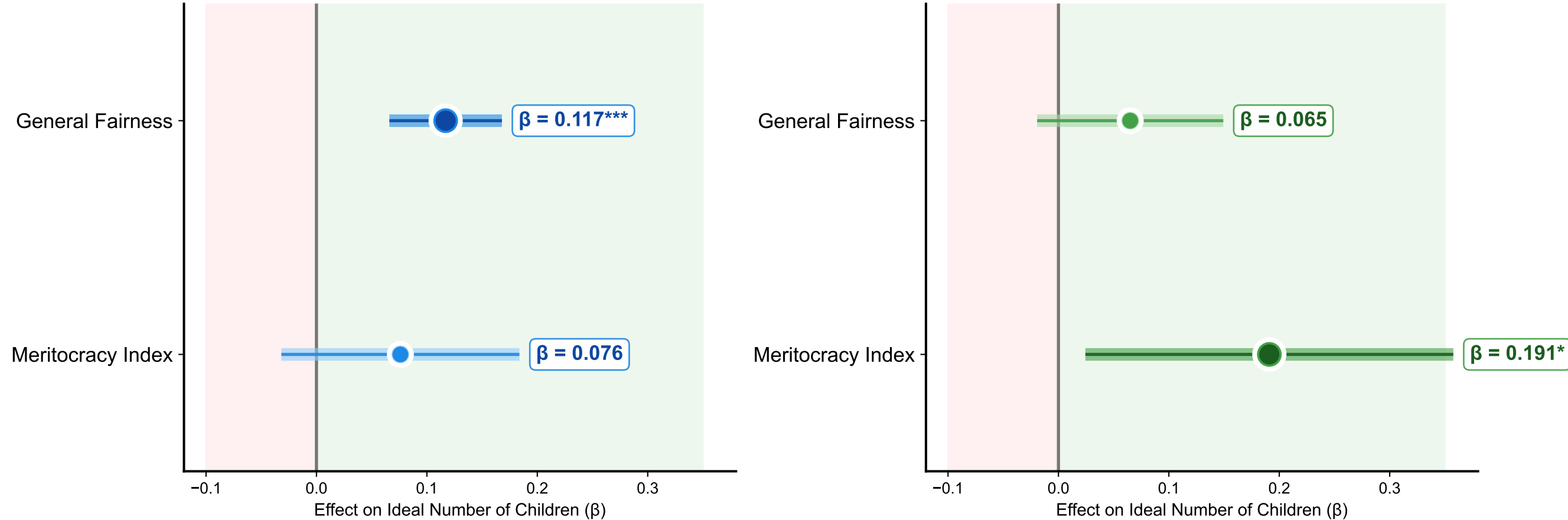


Figure 2: A Tale of Two Pathways
Urban Residents Value General Fairness; Rural Residents Value Meritocracy

Urban Residents
(N = 3,502)

Rural Residents
(N = 1,387)

Significant ($p < 0.05$)
Not Significant



Key Insight: For rural youth, education remains the "great equalizer" — belief that hard work pays off drives fertility intentions. Urban residents, with structural advantages already secured, respond more to the general social climate.